



Arrays — Master Revision Sheet (Step 3, P01–P41)

One-stop revision. Each entry = 📖 **Problem** (what's asked + tiny example) + 📅 **Recall** (the trigger) + 🔧 **Algorithm/idea** + ⚠️ **Trap**.

Go top-to-bottom the night before an interview; every array problem in this step is here.

⚡ 60-Second Index

#	Problem	LC	Pattern	Time / Space
P01	Largest Element	179*	Linear scan	$O(N) / O(1)$
P02	Second Largest	GFG	Two-var single pass	$O(N) / O(1)$
P03	Check Sorted	1752*	Adjacent compare	$O(N) / O(1)$
P04	Remove Duplicates (sorted)	26	Slow/fast pointer	$O(N) / O(1)$
P05/06	Left Rotate by 1 / by D	189	Reversal algorithm	$O(N) / O(1)$
P07	Move Zeros to End	283	Write pointer + swap	$O(N) / O(1)$
P08	Linear Search	GFG	Scan	$O(N) / O(1)$
P09	Union & Intersection (sorted)	GFG	Two pointers	$O(M+N) / O(1)$
P10/13	Missing Number	268	XOR / Sum	$O(N) / O(1)$
P11	Max Consecutive Ones	485	Running counter	$O(N) / O(1)$
P12	Subarray with Given Sum	GFG	Sliding window	$O(N) / O(1)$
P14	Number Appearing Once	136	XOR cancel	$O(N) / O(1)$
P15	Search in 2D Matrix	74	Flattened binary search	$O(\log MN) / O(1)$
P16	Row with Max 1s	GFG	Top-right staircase	$O(M+N) / O(1)$
P17	Two Sum	1	Hash complement	$O(N) / O(N)$
P18	Sort 0s/1s/2s	75	Dutch National Flag	$O(N) / O(1)$
P19	Majority > N/2	169	Boyer-Moore voting	$O(N) / O(1)$
P20/21	Max Subarray Sum	53	Kadane	$O(N) / O(1)$
P22	Stock Buy & Sell	121	Min-so-far	$O(N) / O(1)$
P23	Rearrange Alternating Signs	2149	Two write pointers	$O(N) / O(N)$
P24	Next Permutation	31	Dip → swap → reverse	$O(N) / O(1)$
P25	Leaders in Array	GFG	Suffix max	$O(N) / O(1)$

#	Problem	LC	Pattern	Time / Space
P26	Longest Consecutive Seq	128	Hash set, start-only	$O(N)$ / $O(N)$
P27	Set Matrix Zeroes	73	First row/col as markers	$O(MN)$ / $O(1)$
P28	Rotate Matrix 90°	48	Transpose + reverse rows	$O(N^2)$ / $O(1)$
P29	Spiral Matrix	54	4 shrinking boundaries	$O(MN)$ / $O(1)$
P30	Pascal's Triangle	118/119	$C(r,c)$ build	$O(N^2)$ / $O(1)^*$
P31	Majority > N/3	229	2-candidate voting	$O(N)$ / $O(1)$
P32/33	3Sum / 4Sum	15/18	Sort + two pointers	$O(N^2)/O(N^3)$
P34/35	0-Sum / XOR=K subarrays	GFG/LC	Prefix + hash map	$O(N)$ / $O(N)$
P36	Merge Intervals	56	Sort by start, merge	$O(N \log N)$ / $O(N)$
P37	Merge Sorted Array	88	Three pointers from back	$O(M+N)$ / $O(1)$
P38	Repeating & Missing	GFG	Sum & sum-of-squares	$O(N)$ / $O(1)$
P39	Count Inversions	GFG	Merge sort count	$O(N \log N)$ / $O(N)$
P40	Reverse Pairs	493	Merge sort, count first	$O(N \log N)$ / $O(N)$
P41	Max Product Subarray	152	Track max & min	$O(N)$ / $O(1)$

* variant / amortized

Pattern Toolbox (techniques that repeat)

- **Reversal trick** (P05/06): rotate by $D = \text{reverse}[0,D-1] + \text{reverse}[D,N-1] + \text{reverse all}$. `D %= N` first.
- **Slow/fast (write) pointer** (P04, P07, P18, P23): one pointer writes the "kept" region, other scans.
- **Boyer-Moore voting** (P19, P31): cancel out non-candidates; $N/2 \rightarrow 1$ candidate, $N/3 \rightarrow 2$ candidates, **always verify** when not guaranteed.
- **XOR magic** (P10, P14): `a^a=0`, `a^0=a` → pairs cancel, no overflow.
- **Prefix sum/XOR + hash map** (P12, P34, P35): "subarray with property" → store prefix, look up complement. Seed `map[0]=1`.
- **Sort + two pointers** (P09, P32, P33): collapse a nested loop into linear inner scan; skip duplicates.
- **Merge-sort-while-counting** (P39, P40): count cross-pairs during merge (or before, for Reverse Pairs).
- **Matrix as 1D** (P15): index `(mid/cols, mid%cols)` to binary-search a row-sorted matrix.
- **Staircase walk** (P16): start at a corner so each step eliminates a full row or column.



Problem-by-Problem

P01 — Largest Element · O(N)/O(1)

-  **Problem:** Find the biggest number in an array. `[3,2,1,5,6,4]` → `6`.
-  **Recall:** Init `maxVal = arr[0]`, update `maxVal = max(maxVal, arr[i])`.
- Linear scan; sorting is overkill. STL: `*max_element`.
-  Don't init to `0` — fails on all-negative arrays.

P02 — Second Largest (no sort) · O(N)/O(1)

-  **Problem:** Find the 2nd largest **distinct** value in one pass. `[12,35,1,10,34,1]` → `34`. All-equal `[10,10,10]` → `-1`.
-  **Recall:** Track `largest` & `second`. New largest → `second=largest, largest=x`. New second → `x>second && x!=largest`.
- Single pass, two variables. Return `-1` if no valid second.
-  Must check `x != largest` or duplicates corrupt `second`.

P03 — Check if Sorted · O(N)/O(1)

-  **Problem:** Is the array in non-decreasing (ascending, dups allowed) order? `[1,2,3,4,5]` → true, `[1,3,2,4]` → false.
-  **Recall:** Any `arr[i] > arr[i+1]` → false.
-  Use `>` not `>=` for non-decreasing (`[1,1,2]` is sorted).

P04 — Remove Duplicates from Sorted Array · O(N)/O(1)

-  **Problem:** Sorted array — delete duplicates in-place, return count of uniques. `[0,0,1,1,2,2,3,3,4]` → `5`, front = `[0,1,2,3,4,...]`.
-  **Recall:** `i=0` write ptr. For `j` from 1: if `arr[j]!=arr[i]` → `arr[++i]=arr[j]`. Return `i+1`.
- Works because sorted ⇒ duplicates are adjacent. In-place, no extra space.
-  Start `j` at 1, not 0.

P05 / P06 — Left Rotate by 1 / by D · O(N)/O(1)

-  **Problem:** Shift elements left. By 1: `[1,2,3,4,5]` → `[2,3,4,5,1]`. By D=2: `[1,2,3,4,5]` → `[3,4,5,1,2]`.
-  **Recall:** `d%=n`. `reverse[0,d-1]` + `reverse[d,n-1]` + reverse all.
-  **Algorithm (by D):** ① `d %= n` ② reverse first `d` ③ reverse last `n-d` ④ reverse whole array.
- By 1: save `arr[0]`, shift all left, place saved at end. Right-rotate by D ≡ left-rotate by N-D.
-  Forgetting `d %= n` → out-of-bounds / wasted work.

P07 — Move Zeros to End · O(N)/O(1)

-  **Problem:** Push all 0s to the end in-place, keep order of non-zeros.
`[0,1,0,3,12] → [1,3,12,0,0]` .
-  **Recall:** Write ptr `j=0` . If `arr[i]!=0` → `swap(arr[i], arr[j++])` .
-  No extra array — must be in-place. Same write-pointer pattern as P04.

P08 — Linear Search · O(N)/O(1)

-  **Problem:** Return index of `target` , or `-1` . `[2,3,4,10,40]` , `t=10` → `3` .
-  **Recall:** Scan L → R, return index on match, `-1` if exhausted.
-  If array is sorted, interviewer likely wants Binary Search (O(log N)).

P09 — Union & Intersection of Sorted Arrays · O(M+N)/O(1)

-  **Problem:** From two sorted arrays, get **Union** (all distinct) and **Intersection** (common). `A=[1,1,2,3,4,5]` , `B=[2,3,4,4,5,6]` → Union `[1,2,3,4,5,6]` , Intersection `[2,3,4,5]` .
-  **Recall:** Two pointers. **Union:** take smaller, skip dups, advance it. **Intersection:** advance both only on match.
-  Also skip duplicates *within* a single array.

P10 / P13 — Missing Number (1..N) · O(N)/O(1)

-  **Problem:** Array holds N-1 of the numbers 1..N; find the one missing. `[1,2,4,6,3,7,8]` , `N=8` → `5` .
-  **Recall:** `XOR(1..N) ^ XOR(arr)` → missing survives. (Or `N(N+1)/2 - sum` .)
- XOR avoids overflow; sum needs `long long` for large N.

P11 — Max Consecutive Ones · O(N)/O(1)

-  **Problem:** Longest run of consecutive 1s in a binary array. `[1,1,0,1,1,1]` → `3` .
-  **Recall:** `count = x==1 ? count+1 : 0` ; track max.
-  Update `maxCount` *before/while* resetting `count` , not after.

P12 — Subarray with Given Sum (positives) · O(N)/O(1)

-  **Problem:** Non-negative array — find a contiguous subarray summing to `S` , return its bounds. `[1,2,3,7,5]` , `S=12` → indices `[2,4]` (= `[2,3,7]`).
-  **Recall:** Sliding window: expand right, shrink left while `sum > S` .
-  **Algorithm:** `l=0, sum=0` . For each `r` : `sum+=arr[r]` ; while `sum>S` : `sum-=arr[l++]` ; if `sum==S` → found `[l,r]` .
-  **Only valid for non-negative arrays.** With negatives → prefix sum + hash map, O(N)/O(N).

P14 — Number Appearing Once (others twice) · O(N)/O(1)

- 📖 **Problem:** Every value appears twice except one; find the loner. `[4,1,2,1,2] → 4`.
- 📝 **Recall:** XOR all elements. Pairs cancel, single remains.
- ⚠️ Sorting is $O(N \log N)$ — XOR beats it.

P15 — Search in 2D Matrix · $O(\log MN)/O(1)$

- 📖 **Problem:** Each row sorted, and every row's first > previous row's last (so the matrix reads as one sorted list). Is `target` present? `[[1,3,5,7],[10,11,16,20],[23,30,34,60]]`, `t=3 → true`.
- 📝 **Recall:** Treat as 1D sorted array; `val = matrix[mid/N][mid%N]`, binary search `[0, M*N-1]`.
- 🔧 **Algorithm:** `lo=0, hi=M*N-1; mid=(lo+hi)/2; val=matrix[mid/N][mid%N]`; standard binary search.
- ⚠️ `N` = number of **columns** (`mid/N` = row, `mid%N` = col).

P16 — Row with Max 1s (each row sorted) · $O(M+N)/O(1)$

- 📖 **Problem:** Binary matrix, each row sorted (0s then 1s). Return index of the row with the most 1s. Return `-1` if none. → row with leftmost first-1 wins.
- 📝 **Recall:** Start top-right. See `1` → record row, `col--`. See `0` → `row++`.
- 🔧 **Algorithm:** `r=0, c=N-1, ans=-1`. While `r<M && c>=0`: if `mat[r][c]==1` → `ans=r, c--`; else `r++`.
- Each step kills a row or a column → linear. ⚠️ Top-left/bottom-right corners don't give this property.

P17 — Two Sum · $O(N)/O(N)$

- 📖 **Problem:** Return the two indices whose values add to `target` (exactly one solution). `[2,7,11,15]`, `t=9 → [0,1]`.
- 📝 **Recall:** Hash map. For each `x`: if `target-x` in map → answer; else store `x→i`.
- ⚠️ Check complement **then** insert. Variant: sorted array + only yes/no → two pointers, $O(1)$ space.

P18 — Sort 0s/1s/2s (Dutch National Flag) · $O(N)/O(1)$

- 📖 **Problem:** Array of only 0/1/2 — sort in-place, single pass. `[2,0,2,1,1,0] → [0,0,1,1,2,2]`.
- 📝 **Recall:** `lo=mid=0, hi=n-1`. `0` → `swap(lo,mid), lo++, mid++`. `1` → `mid++`. `2` → `swap(mid,hi), hi--` (don't move mid).
- 🔧 **Algorithm:** invariant — `[0,lo)` = 0s, `[lo,mid)` = 1s, `(hi,end]` = 2s, `[mid,hi]` = unknown. Loop while `mid<hi`.
- ⚠️ After swapping with `hi`, do **not** advance `mid` (unknown element just arrived).

P19 — Majority Element > $N/2$ · $O(N)/O(1)$

- 📖 **Problem:** Find the value occurring more than $N/2$ times (guaranteed to exist).
`[2,2,1,1,1,2,2] → 2`.
- 📖 **Recall:** Boyer-Moore: `candidate+count`. Match → `count++`, else `count--`; `count==0` → new candidate.
- 🔧 **Algorithm:** intuition — the majority outnumbers everything else combined, so pairwise cancellation leaves it standing.
- ⚠️ Verify candidate in a second pass if majority isn't guaranteed.

P20 / P21 — Kadane's Max Subarray (sum / + indices) · $O(N)/O(1)$

- 📖 **Problem:** Max sum of a contiguous subarray (P21 also returns its start/end).
`[-2,1,-3,4,-1,2,1,-5,4] → 6` (`[4,-1,2,1]`). Empty subarray not allowed.
- 📖 **Recall:** `currentSum = max(arr[i], currentSum + arr[i])`; track `maxSum`. (Reset on negative drag.)
- Indices: set `tempStart=i` on fresh start; commit `start=tempStart, end=i` on new max.
- ⚠️ Init `maxSum = arr[0]`, **not 0** (all-negative case). Circular variant (LC 918) = `max(Kadane, total - minSubarray)`.

P22 — Stock Buy & Sell (single transaction) · $O(N)/O(1)$

- 📖 **Problem:** Buy one day, sell a later day, maximize profit. `[7,1,5,3,6,4] → 5` (buy 1, sell 6);
`[7,6,4,3,1] → 0`.
- 📖 **Recall:** Track `minPrice` so far; `maxProfit = max(maxProfit, price - minPrice)`.
- Compute profit with old min, then update min.

P23 — Rearrange Alternating Signs (equal counts) · $O(N)/O(N)$

- 📖 **Problem:** Reorder so signs alternate starting positive, preserving relative order. Equal +/- counts. `[3,1,-2,-5,2,-4] → [3,-2,1,-5,2,-4]`.
- 📖 **Recall:** Positives → even idx (0,2,4...), negatives → odd idx (1,3,5...); step by 2.
- 🔧 **Algorithm:** `pos=0, neg=1`. For each `x`: if `x>=0` → `res[pos]=x, pos+=2`; else `res[neg]=x, neg+=2`.
- ⚠️ Different approach needed if counts unequal — read constraints.

P24 — Next Permutation · $O(N)/O(1)$

- 📖 **Problem:** Rearrange in-place to the lexicographically next-greater permutation; if largest (descending), wrap to smallest. `[1,2,3] → [1,3,2]`, `[3,2,1] → [1,2,3]`, `[1,1,5] → [1,5,1]`.
- 📖 **Recall:** Rightmost dip `i` (`arr[i]<arr[i+1]`) → rightmost `arr[j]>arr[i]` → `swap(i,j)` → reverse suffix after `i`.
- 🔧 **Algorithm:** ① scan from right for first `i` with `arr[i]<arr[i+1]` ② from right find `j` with `arr[j]>arr[i]` ③ swap ④ reverse `arr[i+1...]`.

-  No dip (fully descending) → just reverse the whole array.

P25 — Leaders in Array · $O(N)/O(1)$

-  **Problem:** An element is a "leader" if greater than everything to its right (rightmost always is).
[16,17,4,3,5,2] → [17,5,2].
-  **Recall:** Scan **right** → **left**, keep `maxRight`. If `arr[i] > maxRight` → leader, update.
-  Left → right checking all right elements is $O(N^2)$; reverse the result at the end to restore order.

P26 — Longest Consecutive Sequence · $O(N)/O(N)$

-  **Problem:** Length of the longest run of consecutive integers (any order). Must be $O(N)$.
[100,4,200,1,3,2] → 4 (1,2,3,4).
-  **Recall:** Hash set. Only start counting where `num-1 ∉ set` (a sequence start); walk chain.
-  **Algorithm:** put all in set. For each `num` with `num-1` absent: `len=1`; while `num+len` in set: `len++`; update max.
-  The "start-only" guard is what keeps it $O(N)$; expanding from every element → $O(N^2)$.

P27 — Set Matrix Zeroes (in-place) · $O(MN)/O(1)$

-  **Problem:** If a cell is 0, zero its entire row and column, in-place. [[1,1,1],[1,0,1],[1,1,1]] → [[1,0,1],[0,0,0],[1,0,1]].
-  **Recall:** Use first row/col as markers (with separate flags for them). Mark → apply inner → zero first row/col last.
-  **Algorithm:** ① record if row0/col0 themselves contain a 0 (two flags) ② for inner cells, a 0 sets `mat[i][0]` & `mat[0][j]` ③ apply markers to inner cells ④ finally zero row0/col0 per flags.
-  Zero the first row/col **after** applying markers, never before (cascades).

P28 — Rotate Matrix 90° Clockwise · $O(N^2)/O(1)$

-  **Problem:** Rotate an $N \times N$ matrix 90° clockwise, in-place. [[1,2,3],[4,5,6],[7,8,9]] → [[7,4,1],[8,5,2],[9,6,3]].
-  **Recall:** Transpose (swap `[i][j] ↔ [j][i]` for `j > i`) then reverse each row.
-  **Algorithm:** ① transpose upper triangle ② reverse every row. (Counter-clockwise: transpose then reverse each **column**.)
-  Transpose only `j > i`, else you swap twice and undo it.

P29 — Spiral Matrix · $O(MN)/O(1)$

-  **Problem:** Output all elements in clockwise spiral order. [[1,2,3,4],[5,6,7,8],[9,10,11,12]] → [1,2,3,4,8,12,11,10,9,5,6,7].
-  **Recall:** 4 boundaries top/bottom/left/right. top → right ↓ bottom ← left ↑; shrink after each; guard `top ≤ bottom` & `left ≤ right`.

- 🔧 **Algorithm:** loop while `top ≤ bottom && left ≤ right` : walk top row (left → right), `top++` ; right col (top → bottom), `right--` ; if `top ≤ bottom` bottom row (right → left), `bottom--` ; if `left ≤ right` left col (bottom → top), `left++` .
- ⚠️ Missing the two guards double-counts a middle row/column.

P30 — Pascal's Triangle (3 variants) · $O(N^2)/O(1)$ per row

- 📖 **Problem:** Triangle where each entry = sum of the two above; entry at row r , col $c = C(r, c)$. Variants: ① print N rows ② print N th row ③ value at (R, C) .
- 📖 **Recall:** Element = `C(r, c)` . Build a row in $O(N)$: `row[k] = row[k-1] * (n-k+1) / k` , start 1.
- Full triangle: `row[j] = above[j-1] + above[j]` .
- ⚠️ Numerator is `(n-k+1)` , not `(n-k)` — common off-by-one.

P31 — Majority Element > $N/3$ · $O(N)/O(1)$

- 📖 **Problem:** Find all values appearing more than $N/3$ times (**at most 2** can).
`[1, 1, 1, 3, 3, 2, 2, 2]` → `[1, 2]` .
- 📖 **Recall:** Two candidates, two counts. Match → ++; both zero → assign; else both--. **Then verify both.**
- 🔧 **Algorithm:** extended Boyer-Moore with `cand1, cnt1, cand2, cnt2` ; second pass counts real occurrences and keeps those `> N/3` .
- ⚠️ Verification pass is mandatory — voting candidates aren't guaranteed.

P32 / P33 — 3Sum / 4Sum · $O(N^2) / O(N^3)$

- 📖 **Problem:** Find all **unique** triplets summing to 0 (3Sum) / quadruplets summing to `target` (4Sum). `[-1, 0, 1, 2, -1, -4]` → `[[-1, -1, 2], [-1, 0, 1]]` .
- 📖 **Recall:** Sort. **3Sum:** fix `i` , two pointers `l=i+1, r=n-1` for `-arr[i]` . **4Sum:** fix `i, j` , then two pointers; use `long long` .
- 🔧 **Algorithm:** sort first. For each fixed index, move `l, r` inward: `sum < target` → `l++` , `>` → `r--` , `==` → record & skip dups on both sides.
- ⚠️ Dup-skip guard is `if (i > 0 && arr[i] == arr[i-1]) continue;` .

P34 / P35 — Largest 0-Sum Subarray / Count XOR=K · $O(N)/O(N)$

- 📖 **Problem:** **P34:** length of the longest subarray summing to 0. `[15, -2, 2, -8, 1, 7, 10, 23]` → `5` .
P35: count subarrays whose XOR = K .
- 📖 **Recall:** **P34:** same prefix sum seen again → zero-sum subarray; store **first** occurrence; `len = i - firstSeen[prefix]` . **P35:** `count += freq[xorPref ^ K]` , then `freq[xorPref]++` ; seed `freq[0]=1` .
- 🔧 **Why it works:** if `prefix[i] == prefix[j]` the segment between them sums to 0. For XOR: a subarray $(j..i)$ has XOR K iff `prefix[i] ^ prefix[j-1] = K` ⇒ `prefix[j-1] = prefix[i] ^ K` .

- ⚠️ P34 stores the **first** occurrence (max length); storing latest gives min length.

P36 — Merge Overlapping Intervals · $O(N \log N)/O(N)$

- 📖 **Problem:** Merge intervals that overlap. `[[1,3],[2,6],[8,10],[15,18]]` → `[[1,6],[8,10],[15,18]]`.
- 📅 **Recall:** Sort by start. If `curr.start ≤ last.end` → merge `last.end = max(last.end, curr.end)`; else push new.
- ⚠️ Must sort first; the overlap check assumes sorted starts.

P37 — Merge Sorted Array (in-place into nums1) · $O(M+N)/O(1)$

- 📖 **Problem:** `nums1` has `m` valid + `n` empty slots; `nums2` has `n`. Merge both sorted into `nums1` in-place. `[1,2,3,0,0,0], m=3` + `[2,5,6]` → `[1,2,2,3,5,6]`.
- 📅 **Recall:** Three pointers from the back: `p1=m-1`, `p2=n-1`, `p=m+n-1`; place larger at `nums1[p]`. Drain remaining `nums2`.
- 🔧 **Algorithm:** while `p2 ≥ 0`: if `p1 ≥ 0 && nums1[p1] > nums2[p2]` → `nums1[p--] = nums1[p1--]` else `nums1[p--] = nums2[p2--]`.
- ⚠️ Merge from the **back** — front merge overwrites unread `nums1` values.

P38 — Find Repeating & Missing · $O(N)/O(1)$

- 📖 **Problem:** Numbers 1..N each once, except one repeats and one is missing — find both. `[4,3,6,2,1,1]` → repeat `1`, missing `5`.
- 📅 **Recall:** `d1 = sum - N(N+1)/2 = R-M`; `d2 = sumSq -  $\sum k^2 = R^2 - M^2$` ; `R+M = d2/d1`. Solve the two equations.
- 🔧 **Algorithm:** from `R-M` and `R+M`: `R = ((R-M) + (R+M)) / 2`, `M = R - (R-M)`. (XOR-bucket method is the alternative.)
- ⚠️ Use `long long` — sum of squares overflows.

P39 — Count Inversions · $O(N \log N)/O(N)$

- 📖 **Problem:** Count pairs `(i < j)` with `arr[i] > arr[j]` (how far from sorted). `[2,4,1,3,5]` → `3`; fully reversed → `N(N-1)/2`.
- 📅 **Recall:** Merge sort: when `right[j] < left[i]`, `count += (mid - i + 1)` (all remaining lefts invert).
- 🔧 **Algorithm:** standard merge sort; add the cross-count during the merge step.
- ⚠️ Count must be `long long` (can be $\sim N^2/2$).

P40 — Reverse Pairs (`arr[i] > 2*arr[j]`) · $O(N \log N)/O(N)$

- 📖 **Problem:** Count pairs `(i < j)` with `arr[i] > 2*arr[j]`. `[1,3,2,3,1]` → `2`; `[2,4,3,5,1]` → `3`.
- 📅 **Recall:** Count **first** in a separate pass (`while arr[i] > 2*arr[j]: j++`), **then** merge normally.

-  **Algorithm:** in merge sort, before merging the two sorted halves, count pairs with a dedicated two-pointer scan; then do the ordinary merge.
-  Conditions for counting and merging differ — you can't count during the merge like in inversions. Use `long long` for `2*arr[j]`.

P41 — Maximum Product Subarray · O(N)/O(1)

-  **Problem:** Max product of a contiguous subarray. `[2,3,-2,4] → 6`; `[-2,3,-4] → 24` (two negatives flip to a big positive).
-  **Recall:** Track `maxProd` and `minProd`. `newMax = max(nums[i], maxProd*nums[i], minProd*nums[i])`. Save old max before updating min.
-  **Why min too:** a negative number swaps the roles — the smallest (most negative) product can become the largest. Zero resets both.
-  Pure Kadane (max only) misses the negative-flip; you must keep min.

Last-Minute Trap Checklist

- ☐ Init max/min to `arr[0]`, never `0` (negatives). — P01, P20
- ☐ `d %= n` before rotating. — P05/06
- ☐ Sliding window $\Rightarrow$ non-negative only; negatives need prefix+hash. — P12, P34/35
- ☐ DNF: don't advance `mid` after a `hi` swap. — P18
- ☐ Voting always needs a verify pass when not guaranteed. — P19, P31
- ☐ Merge sorted array & three-pointer tricks go **from the back**. — P37
- ☐ `long long` for sums, squares, inversion/pair counts. — P10, P38, P39, P40
- ☐ Matrix: transpose only `j>i`; spiral needs `top≤bottom` / `left≤right` guards. — P28, P29
- ☐ Max Product keeps **both** max and min. — P41
- ☐ Reverse Pairs: count BEFORE merging (condition $\neq$ merge condition). — P40

Generated from the per-problem notes in this folder (P01–P41). For full dry-runs, code, and interview scripts, open the individual `P##_*.md` files.